THE JDM LEGENDS ARCHIVE / PHOTO & SPECIFICATION EDITION

MIDNIGHT CLUB

LEGENDS NEVER FADE.

Six iconic Japanese performance cars — their engines, factory power figures, engineering stories and the reasons they became legends.

INSIDE THIS EDITION

R34 GT-R • Supra A80 • RX-7 FD
NSX NA1 • Silvia S15 • MX-5 NA

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POWER FIGURES

Factory output varied by market, model year and trim. Japanese-market figures are often quoted in PS under the period's voluntary 280 PS agreement. PS and mechanical horsepower (hp) are not identical. Modified-car dyno figures are not used here.

LEGEND 01 / THE GODZILLA GENERATION

NISSAN SKYLINE GT-R R34

1999–2002 • JAPANESE PERFORMANCE ICON

OPEN REAL CAR PHOTO ■

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ENGINE	FACTORY POWER
RB26DETT • 2.6L twin-turbo inline-six	**280 PS / 276 hp (Japanese official rating)**
DRIVETRAIN	**WHY IT BECAME FAMOUS**
ATTESA E-TS all-wheel drive	Its RB26 engine became a tuning legend, while the ATTESA E-TS AWD system and Super-HICAS rear steering gave it serious technology for its era. A starring role in games and car culture helped make the R34 a global icon.

QUICK FACT

The R34 GT-R introduced the multifunction display that could show live vehicle information.

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LEGEND 02 / THE 2JZ LEGEND

TOYOTA SUPRA A80 / MK4

1993–2002 • JAPANESE PERFORMANCE ICON

OPEN REAL CAR PHOTO ■

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ENGINE	FACTORY POWER
2JZ-GTE • 3.0L twin-turbo inline-six (turbo models)	**280 PS / 276 hp (Japanese-market turbo rating; export versions differed)**
DRIVETRAIN	**WHY IT BECAME FAMOUS**
Rear-wheel drive	The 2JZ-GTE's strong design, smooth inline-six character and huge aftermarket support made the A80 a favourite for high-performance builds. Its long bonnet, rounded shape and motorsport presence made it instantly recognisable.

QUICK FACT

The A80 used a six-speed Getrag manual on selected turbo models.

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LEGEND 03 / THE ROTARY ICON

MAZDA RX-7 FD

1992–2002 • JAPANESE PERFORMANCE ICON

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ENGINE	FACTORY POWER
13B-REW • 1.3L twin-rotor sequential twin-turbo	**255–280 PS (varies by year and market; late Japanese models rated 280 PS)**
DRIVETRAIN	**WHY IT BECAME FAMOUS**
Rear-wheel drive	The RX-7 paired a compact rotary engine with a lightweight, balanced chassis. Its sequential turbo system, low bonnet and flowing design made it stand apart from conventional piston-engine sports cars.

QUICK FACT

The 13B-REW uses two triangular rotors rather than conventional pistons.

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LEGEND 04 / THE EVERYDAY SUPERCAR

HONDA NSX NA1

1990–2005 • JAPANESE PERFORMANCE ICON

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ENGINE	FACTORY POWER
C30A • 3.0L naturally aspirated V6 (early NA1)	**270 hp (early North American 3.0L model; ratings varied by market)**
DRIVETRAIN	**WHY IT BECAME FAMOUS**
Rear-wheel drive; mid-engine layout	The NSX brought supercar performance together with Honda reliability goals, visibility and everyday usability. Its aluminium-intensive monocoque and precise chassis challenged expectations of what a supercar could be.

QUICK FACT

Ayrton Senna gave input during the NSX's chassis development programme.

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LEGEND 05 / THE DRIFT FAVOURITE

NISSAN SILVIA S15

1999–2002 • JAPANESE PERFORMANCE ICON

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ENGINE	FACTORY POWER
SR20DET • 2.0L turbo inline-four (Spec-R)	**250 PS / 247 hp (Spec-R factory rating)**
DRIVETRAIN	**WHY IT BECAME FAMOUS**
Rear-wheel drive	Compact dimensions, rear-wheel drive, balanced handling and the tunable SR20DET helped the S15 become a favourite in drifting and grassroots motorsport. Its clean proportions remain popular with builders.

QUICK FACT

The S15 was the final generation of the Silvia line sold new in Japan.

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LEGEND 06 / THE LIGHTWEIGHT ROADSTER

MAZDA MX-5 / MIATA NA

1989–1997 • JAPANESE PERFORMANCE ICON

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ENGINE	FACTORY POWER
B6 1.6L or BP 1.8L naturally aspirated inline-four	**Approx. 115 hp (early 1.6L US) to 128 hp (1.8L US); market/year dependent**
DRIVETRAIN	**WHY IT BECAME FAMOUS**
Front-engine, rear-wheel drive	The original MX-5 revived the affordable lightweight roadster formula: low weight, simple mechanicals, balanced handling and an open-top driving experience. It became one of the world's best-known roadsters.

QUICK FACT

The first-generation MX-5 helped inspire a modern revival of the classic British-style roadster.

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